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CONTACT DETAILS FOR ANY SUPPORT



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BASIC SUGAR GLIDER INFORMATION



CONSERVATION STATUS: The sugar glider is not considered endangered, and its conservation rank is "Least Concern (LC)" on the International Union for Conservation of Nature Red List (<http://www.iucnredlist.org/details/16731/0>)

HEAD-BODY LENGTH:	170 mm (160 mm - 210 mm)
TAIL LENGTH:	190 mm (165 mm - 210 mm)
WEIGHT:	Males - 140 grams (115 grams – 160 grams) Females - 115 grams (95 grams – 135 grams)
HEART RATE:	200-300 beats per minute
LIFESPAN:	Wild – Up to 9 years Captivity – Up to 12 years
SEXUAL MATURITY:	Males : 4 months to 12 months Females : 8 months to 12 months

WHAT IS A SUGAR GLIDER



The Sugar Glider is native to eastern and northern mainland Australia, who is small, omnivorous, arboreal gliding possum belonging to the marsupial infraclass. They have the ability to glide through the air through flaps or membranes of loose skin which extend between the fifth finger of each hand to the first toe of each foot. It launches itself from a tree, spreading its limbs to expose the gliding membranes and creates an aerofoil enabling them to glide 50 metres or more. By evading predators and locating food, they glide from tree to tree.

Sugar Gliders are nocturnal and sleep in their nests during the day and are active at night. At night they will hunt insects, small vertebrates and feed on the sweet sap of certain species of eucalyptus, acacia and gum trees. Its large eyes help it to see at night, and its ears swivel to help locate prey in the dark. Sugar Gliders are VERY social animals and live in colonies of up to seven adults.

It has a long tail with a squirrel-like body with five digits on each foot, each having a claw, except for the opposable toe on the hind feet. Also on the hind feet, the second and third digits are partially syndactylous (fused together), forming a grooming comb.

Sugar Glider males are larger than the females and have bald patches on their head and chest (scent glands). There are four scent glands in total, located on their forehead, chest and two paracloacal. They use the scent glands for marking purposes, mainly by the males. A dominant adult male will mark his territory and members of the group with saliva and a scent produced by separate glands on the forehead and chest. The frontal gland is easily seen on an adult male as a bald spot. The male also has a bifurcated penis whereas the female has a pouch (marsupium) in the middle of her abdomen to carry offspring. The sugar glider has a distinctive alarm call, said to resemble the yapping of a dog. Other calls include a high-pitched cry, and buzzing, screaming and hissing sounds.

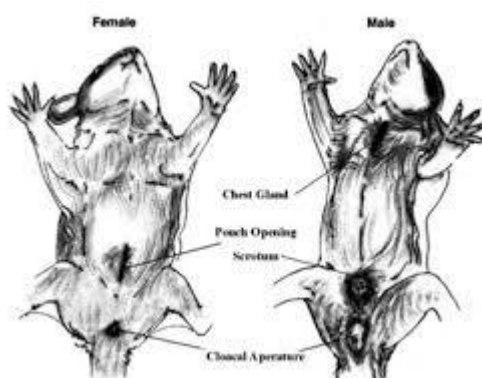
Sugar Gliders have thick and very soft fur coats which is blue-grey, some have been known to be yellow, tan, or leucistic. A black stripe is seen from its nose to midway on its back. Its belly, throat, and chest are cream in colour.

In the wild Sugar Gliders are seasonally adapted omnivores with a wide variety of foods in their diet. In summer they are primarily insectivorous, and in the winter when insects are scarce, they are mostly exudativorous, feeding on acacia gum, eucalyptus sap, manna, honeydew or lerp. They eat a variety of foods, eg. lizards, small birds, worms, nectar, acacia seeds, bird eggs, pollen, fungi and native fruits.

Male Sugar Gliders will be sexual mature between 4 and 12 months, whereas the females will be between 8 and 12 months. Sugar Gliders breed once or twice a year in the wild, while they may breed more in captivity. The female's gestation period is approximately 15 to 17 days, after which the tiny joey, which weighs 0.2 g, will crawl into her mother's pouch for further development. They are born with a continuous arc of cartilage in their shoulder girdle to provide support for climbing into the pouch. This structure breaks down immediately after birth. The joey(s) will attach itself to its mother's nipple, where it will stay for about 60 to 70 days. The mother can get pregnant while her joeys are still in the pouch and hold the pregnancy until the pouch is available. The joey gradually spills out of the pouch until it falls out completely. It emerges virtually without fur, and the eyes will remain closed for another 12–14 days. During this time, the joey will begin to mature by growing fur and increasing gradually in size. It takes about two months for the offspring to be completely weaned, and at four months, the young glider is on its own.

SEXING A JOEY

Every joey has an extension from the cloaca when they come out of pouch. This extension is commonly mistaken for a penis. To determine the sex of a joey, you need to look for a pouch on a female, and the scrotum on the male. Both the pouch and scrotom are located on the belly where you typically would expect to see a "belly-button".



NUTRITION



Sugar gliders are omnivorous meaning they eat a variety of foods. In the wild, Sugar gliders feed mostly on insects in the summer, but in the winter when insects are scarce, they mostly feed on the sweet sap of certain species of eucalyptus, acacia and gum trees, manna (a crusty sugar left from where sap flowed from a wound in a tree trunk or branch), honeydew and lerp and therefore require a relatively high protein diet.

That is why we trust in fresh fruits and vegetables with chicken fillets and lots of mealworms.

It is estimated that over 90% of all the health problems Veterinarians seen in Sugar Gliders are directly related to poor diets that owners innocently found on the Internet. According to multiple Veterinary studies, these diets often contain excessive levels of sugar and fat and they lack the wide range of vital nutrients, vitamins and essential minerals that are required by domestic Sugar Gliders. While Sugar Gliders usually love these “junk food” diets, they often begin to suffer from obesity, bone disease and a wide range of other health problems.

RECOMMENDED FRESH DIET FOR YOUR HEALTHY SUGAR GLIDER

There are several different theories on what you should feed a sugar glider on a daily basis. But most sugar glider experts agree that these wonderful animals, when raised in captivity, require fresh fruit, fresh vegetables and protein (in the form of chicken fillet). We recommend fresh food every day and allot of mealworms. We have healthy gliders and we believe it is because of this diet and of course the loving care we give our sweethearts on a daily basis. We know that our diet takes a little more time to prepare than powdered versions, but it is well worth your time. Your sugar gliders will thank you, always give compliments to the chef. Avoid feeding anything with preservatives, sugar or color additives. Gliders in the wild eat very low fat diets and get lots of exercise gliding through the rain forest. Gliders raised in captivity, without a healthy diet, can become fat and develop health problems.

Sugar gliders are very active animals with high metabolisms. Therefore it is important that you keep staple food in their cage at all times. In addition, we recommend you serve them a fresh diet on a daily basis in late afternoon, periodically provide healthy treats and mealworms. And of course make sure they have fresh filtered water at all times.

Staple - Cereal: The premium cereal we use is Nestle's Nestum Baby Cereal (First Cereal). We recommend 1-2 teaspoons per glider per day. Throw out old cereal in the morning, clean the bowl and put fresh cereal in the afternoon. (This item is at most Spar's, Pick & Pay's and Checkers)

Fresh Diet (and protein): Most fruit and vegetables (see list below of recommended fruit and vegetables). This must be cut up every night, together with cooked chicken fillet (protein). Eggs (protein) may be given in moderation. Frozen vegetables may be given, but we recommend fresh vegetables. 1 ½ - 2 tablespoons per glider per day served in late afternoon. Please don't forget a lot of mealworms!

{meals can also be made in bigger batches and frozen in portions, unfreeze fresh portion daily}

List of fruit:	List of vegetables:
Papaya	Carrots
Pineapple	Sweet Potatoes
Oranges	Corn
Apples	Broccoli
Grapes	Brussel Sprouts
Watermelon	Cabbage
Cantaloupe	Celery
Cranberries	Cucumber
Blueberries	Eggplant
Bananas	French Beans
Plums	Green Beans
Apricots	Tomatoes
Cherries	
Grapefruit	
Pears	
Rasberries	
Strawberries	
Mango	
Peaches	

Protein: Favourites include cooked chicken, ground turkey and eggs. You can boil, broil or roast the chicken and scramble the eggs. We do not recommend you give your sugar gliders pork or beef because of the high fat content and once again, fat gliders are not happy and healthy.

The sugar gliders high diet of fruits and vegetables contains inverse amounts of phosphorous to calcium. High phosphorus and low calcium leaches calcium from their bones making the bones brittle and easily broken or fractured. Calcium deficiency will make your glider sick, then will cause hind leg or total paralysis, and will kill them. If you notice any trembling or shaking (on a consistent basis, not just when scared), or any trouble climbing in the cage or hanging on to the perch, contact your exotic animal vet immediately. Neocalglucon or Calciquid (calcium gluconate in a sweet syrup), is an excellent product to rebuild calcium quickly, your vet (one who is very knowledgeable in sugar gliders – see details of vet below) can instruct you on how much and how often to give this calcium supplement. Do not feed these high phosphorous foods: beef, most seeds, nuts and cottage cheese – eliminate these foods from your gliders diet. Corn is also high in phosphorus and should be fed sparingly and an occasional almond is fine. Just think moderation. Prevention is your safest bet, so use vitamins daily.

A teaspoon of low fat yogurt may be added to your fresh mix.

Fresh Water: You must be sure to provide your sugar glider with fresh water daily. We recommend you use filtered water and never let your water bottle be empty. As an additional beverage, you can mix ½ filtered water with ½ 100% fruit juice; like 100% apple juice, but we recommend that only 3 times per week.

Mealworms: The favourite treat of a sugar glider is the live mealworm. It is a high protein treat and can be given to them on a daily basis – no more than 10-12 medium sized mealworms per glider. It is also a great treat to use when bonding with your sugar glider or having fun hand feeding your pet.

Treats: Other treats that seem to make sugar gliders happy are yogurt drops (hard to find), dried cherry drops, dried mealworms, dried crickets. Also cutting up fresh fruit such as watermelon and oranges, or sweet potatoes will make your sugar gliders jump for joy.

WE DO NOT RECOMMEND THE FOLLOWING

Chocolate of any kind, candy of any variety, bread, cat food, dog food, seeds or any food with high sugar content. We do not feed our gliders any type of nuts. An occasional non-seasoned raw almond would be ok, but our rule is NO NUTS. Any vegetable that is high in phosphorous is not good for sugar gliders. And we ask (pretty please) that you do your homework before you buy any item that is pre-mixed, has more than one ingredient, claims to be the answer to all your needs, or seems to be too good to be true. Your new best friend(s) depend on you to keep them safe, healthy and happy. Do not feed your glider garlic, Rhubarb, leeks and onions.

CARE

After learning all about Sugar Gliders and deciding whether it will be a boy or girl, you need to take into consideration that his/her home needs to be completed before your new baby arrives.

CAGE REQUIREMENTS

Sugar Gliders are tree-dwelling animals, which means the higher the cage, the more place there will be for them to jump and glide! Wire cages are always the best for a Sugar Glider and a nice size cage will be approximately 130 cm x 70 cm x 45 cm.

Sugar Gliders love toys – always ensure that you have lots of toys for them like tunnels to run through, perches, climbing ropes, exercise wheel etc. A nesting or sleeping pouch will provide your Sugar Glider with a place to curl up and go to sleep during the day and also a place where it can hide and feel safe. In the wild, sugar gliders nest high up in trees, place the nesting pouch fairly high up in the cage.

Your Sugar Glider's cage will need to be cleaned regularly, a plastic bottom lined with washable fleece is a good choice. Sugar gliders will use their scent glands to make their pouches smell like them, so it is a good idea to have several pouches available in order to rotate them for cleaning; otherwise, the pouches can become quite smelly. Always ensure that you have locks on your cages to prevent dogs, cats, kids or visitors to open the cages!

WHEELS:

Sugar glider wheels should have a mesh track and should not have a crossbar for tails to get caught in. Make sure there are no holes/gaps a paw or tail can get caught in!

Cage setup examples:



BONDING

Bonding is a very important part of your Sugar Glider's routine. The more you bond with your Sugar Glider, the tamer he/she will be. Everybody wants to bond with his/her Sugar Glider in a special way and by handling him/her allot your bond will just grow more and more each day.

When your new baby arrives at home, put your hand in his/her pouch and stroke him/her. Touching him/her allot will make him/her trust you more. He/she might crab, but don't let this put you off – keep on taking him/her out of the cage and hold him/her against your body. Please never pull away from a glider when it tries biting you because he/she will sense fear and he/she will keep on biting.

Gliders bond by scent and it is advisable to put a piece of your old clothes in his/her nest to enable him/her to have your scent with him/her. This way he/she will get used to your smell.

I have found that my best bonding time with my Sugar Gliders are when I feed them meal worms by hand – this is the best and most nutritional snack you can ever give your Sugar Gliders.



GENERAL

Sugar Gliders (like many other animals) needs a mate. If kept alone, they will eventually lack companionship while you are fast asleep at night. Depression can lead to a variety of disorders from overeating, to barking the whole night through. I would recommend housing at least 2 Sugar Gliders together.

Remember, in the wild Sugar Gliders live in colonies which means that they will get lonely without a companion. Love your Sugar Glider a lot and build a strong bond with him/her. Give him/her proper care and nutrition and he/she will be your best friend.

If you notice any symptom of your Sugar Glider being sick, please take him/her immediately to a vet who specializes in exotic animals.

Please note that in captivity, Sugar Gliders can suffer from calcium deficiencies if not fed an adequate diet. A lack of calcium in the diet causes the body to leach calcium from the bones, with the hind legs first to show noticeable dysfunction. Their diet should be at least 40% insects or other sources of protein, 25% fruit and 25% vegetables.

HEALTH AND VETERINARY SERVICES

Please be alert for the following symptoms. If you do notice these symptoms, contact your veterinary immediately for treatment:

- slow movement or falling over
- wounds
- shivering or shaking
- flattened ears
- stressed
- sneezing
- discharge from eyes or nose
- overall appearance is not looking well
- dragging limbs, especially back legs or hindquarter
- change in colour
- injuries
- vomiting
- wet neck and tummy
- no eating or drinking
- loss of hair
- weight loss
- sitting in a corner of a cage and not being active

DISORDERS AND DISEASES

Many disorders and diseases that occur in sugar gliders are related to dietary imbalances, including malnutrition, obesity, and vitamin and mineral imbalances.

Others are related to infection with bacteria, fungi, or parasites.

Aflatoxicosis

Aflatoxicosis is a liver disease caused by toxins produced by certain fungi in or on foods and feeds. Corn, peanuts, and cotton-seed are the most likely to be contaminated with aflatoxins. Sugar gliders can get aflatoxicosis by eating contaminated peanuts or by eating crickets that have been fed contaminated corn. Therefore, it is important not to feed your sugar gliders peanuts and to know what kind of feed your insect supplier feeds its insects. Signs of aflatoxicosis are loss of appetite, anemia, jaundice, lack of energy, and diarrhea. Sudden death may occur. If diagnosed in time, aflatoxicosis is reversible.

Take your sugar glider to a veterinarian immediately, and change its feed.

Constipation

Small, hard, dry animal droppings, or none at all, may be a sign of constipation. Possible causes of constipation are not enough liquids or fiber in the diet, poor overall diet, stress, lack of exercise, or digestive system problems. Some medications can also cause this problem. A medical examination by a veterinarian to determine the cause should be performed as soon as constipation is noticed.

Diarrhea and Vomiting

Several microscopic parasites, including *Cryptosporidium*, *Giardia*, and *Trichomonas* can cause diarrhea and occasional vomiting in sugar gliders, along with abdominal cramps, weight loss, and dehydration. Your veterinarian can perform tests to determine the cause of these signs and prescribe the appropriate medication. Because several of these parasites can also infect humans, it is important to use care when handling sick sugar gliders and to wash your hands thoroughly after cleaning the cage and before touching any food or any item that will be near your mouth. Until a followup test shows that the parasite has been eliminated, the sugar glider should be quarantined from other pets. The cage should also be thoroughly cleaned to reduce the possibility of reinfection.

Eye Disorders

Sugar gliders may be aggressive and can cause severe trauma to each other, particularly during mating and the introduction of new adults. These injuries often occur

around the face and may include eye injuries and corneal scratches. Corneal scratches may develop slow-healing sores and conjunctivitis (inflammation of the tissue around the eye). Cataracts (white spots in the lens of the eye) also occur in sugar gliders. As in humans, this can lead to blindness.

Leptospirosis

Sugar gliders may become infected with this disease and pass it on to humans if they come into contact with water or food that has been contaminated with *Leptospira* bacteria. Signs include fever, kidney and liver problems. A veterinarian can test for the presence of these bacteria. Strict attention to thorough cage cleaning, food dish and water supply sanitation, and careful hand washing following contact with your pet or its environment are important to prevent both reinfection and transmission to you or other humans.

Lumpy Jaw (Actinomycosis)

Lumpy jaw is a condition in which the bacteria *Actinomyces israelii* infect the face and neck, creating a slowly enlarging, hard lump. The bacteria can also infect the lungs, intestinal tract, and other parts of the body. Discharge from the eyes and weight loss are other signs of infection. The facial tissues can become infected with the bacteria after surgery, trauma, or another infection. A common cause in sugar gliders is an abscess in the mouth. Lumpy jaw is deadly if left untreated; therefore, you should contact your veterinarian immediately if a hard lump appears on the face or neck of your pet or if you notice eye discharges or sudden weight loss. Treatment to get rid of the infection requires a prescribed medication. Because several disease-causing organisms may be involved, your veterinarian will perform tests to determine the most effective medication. Mineral, Vitamin, and Protein Imbalances Hypocalcemia is an abnormally low level of calcium in the blood and is due mainly to an imbalance of dietary calcium, phosphorus, and vitamin D. Not getting enough dietary protein causes hypoproteinemia and anemia (too few red blood cells in the blood). All of these conditions may be caused by longterm malnutrition and can lead to liver and kidney problems. Malnourished sugar gliders are weak and slow to respond, and usually thin and dehydrated. Anemic and hypoproteinemic sugar gliders may also have bruising, abnormal swelling, and pale mucous membranes. Weakened animals may develop additional infections. Treatment requires correcting the underlying dietary problems and providing general supportive care. Follow your veterinarian's advice regarding diet, supplements, water supplies, and environmental conditions.

Metabolic bone disease, also known as nutritional osteodystrophy, is a condition in which there is a softening of the bones due to an imbalance of the minerals calcium and phosphorus. The first signs are a weakening of the muscles in the sugar glider's hind end that progresses to paralysis of the hind legs. This can seem to happen very quickly.

Pneumonia, heart problems, seizures, and broken bones can also occur as a result of this condition. X-rays reveal a loss of bone from the spinal column, pelvis, and long bones in particular. This disease, if treated quickly, can be reversible with proper diet and care. Treatment involves cage rest, giving calcium and vitamin D3 supplements (which your veterinarian may give by injection), and correction of the diet. To help prevent vitamin and mineral imbalances, insects in the diet can be gut-loaded with calcium or sprinkled with a calcium powder before being fed to sugar gliders. The practice of gut loading is a common technique that involves providing insects with a nutritious mixture of cereals and vegetables immediately before being fed to the sugar glider—thus loading their gut with nutrients. Another common practice is the use of powdered vitamin/mineral supplements. Crickets brought home from a pet store and never fed have little nutritional value. Placing them in a bag with vitamin and mineral powders and shaking the bag will coat the insects with the powder. Although some of the powder will fall off, the newer microfine powders adhere remarkably well.

Mites and Fleas

Wild sugar glider nests generally contain a range of host-specific mites and fleas, but these parasites that live on the outside of the body are uncommon in sugar gliders raised in captivity and indoors. Dusting with an insecticide recommended by your veterinarian is effective for controlling fleas and mites. Both the nesting box and the animal should be treated.

Obesity

Obesity can occur in captive sugar gliders that are fed a diet too high in calories. Lack of exercise also adds to the problem. Obesity can lead to heart and liver disease.

Treatment of obesity requires a change in diet and an increase in exercise.

Pasteurellosis

Pasteurella multocida bacteria may spread from rabbits to sugar gliders. This infection is deadly for sugar gliders. Pus-filled, inflamed sores form on various organs, including the skin, causing sudden death.

Polioencephalomalacia

Polioencephalomalacia is a neurologic disease that causes deterioration in parts of the brain. Possible signs are loss of appetite, weight loss, lack of energy, weakness, dizziness, lack of coordination, disorientation, tremors, and gradual paralysis. It has been suggested that nutritional deficiencies may worsen this disease because some sugar gliders appear to have improved when given Vitamin B1 (thiamine); however, the cause of this disease has not yet been determined. A severe case may prove deadly. A balanced and proper diet is most likely the best way to prevent this disease.

Toxoplasmosis

Toxoplasmosis is a disease often found in cats. Sugar gliders can get toxoplasmosis if they come into contact with cat litter or feces that have been contaminated with the parasite *Toxoplasma gondii* or if fed undercooked meats. Signs include lack of coordination, tremors, head tilt, diarrhea, loss of appetite and weight, loss of energy, below normal body temperatures, trouble breathing, and sudden death. This parasite can also be passed to humans; the signs include fever, sore throat and muscles, and loss of vision. The parasite is particularly dangerous for pregnant women; infection can cause miscarriage or birth defects. People with weakened immune systems are also very susceptible to becoming ill after contact with this parasite. To control this parasite, do not allow your sugar glider(s) to come in contact with a cat's litter box, provide only thoroughly cooked meats, and use gloves and thorough hand washing when handling cat litter.

Tumors

Tumors, particularly lymphoid neoplasia, are common in opossum and glider species. Tumors have been found in the spleen, liver, kidney, pouch, jaw, and lymph nodes of sugar gliders.

Sugar Glider Vet Contact Details:

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EVERYTHING YOUR NEW BABY NEEDS

Book – All about Sugar Gliders and how to breed mealworms.

Cage (approximately 130 cm x 70 cm x 45 cm).

Food Bowls and Water bottle.

Nest with fleece blanket to sleep in. Extra fleece blanket.

Lots of Toys : Play mobile or hanging hideaway, Glider Bridge, Play tunnel, Sekelbos swings and an Exercise wheel.

Pouch for bonding.

Food (fresh food – refer to list of fruits and vegetables):

Complete meal worm breeding box (see how to breed with meal worms)

HOW TO BREED WITH MEAL WORMS

About Mealworms

Mealworms are a great protein source for Sugar Gliders. Mealworms are fantastic feeders and there are many reasons why you might want to breed your own, since sometimes it's hard to find mealworms at a local pet shop and when you do the prices are very high. After getting them you will be uncertain of how well they have been kept along with what they have been fed. Breeding your own mealworms can save you money and give you healthier, happier Sugar Gliders. First you need a place to store your mealworms. Plastic bin multi-drawer units work very well for storing mealworms. There are many types of these plastic bins and they are just the thing for breeding mealworms.

Once you have your worms you need to store them in bedding. This will act as much of their diet and something for them to crawl around in. You can use wheat bran or rolled oats, along with many other forms of wheat and some cereals. I find that bran is the best to use. It's cheap and easy to find at local stores (Any Spar/Bakers Bin) or even your own food store. Wheat bran is also tiny enough for your worms to eat and much easier to clean. Pour enough so there is an inch of wheat bran in your bin. I usually begin with 1 medium bag then replace it with new wheat bran every month or so (depending on the quantity worms).

Cleaning

Your mealworm bin will need little cleaning. Bins should never ever be damp, grow mold, or have a moldy smell to them. Every so often you might need to replace bedding. Do this by taking the bin and 2 other empty bins to a table. Using a kitchen sifter, place a small amount of worms and bedding at a time into the sifter and place it over one of the empty bins. You shake and vibrate the sifter and you will notice the bedding falling in to the bin and keeping the worms in the sifter. Once cleared of all bedding, toss worms that remain in the sifter into the other empty bin. Repeat this step until all worms are in the other bin. Once you are done you can throw out the material you shook into the empty bin, which is actually poop left over by the worms. This is a good time to take the bin of worms and Hand pick out any food left behind, dead mealworms or pupa. Once the worms are cleaned, fill their other bin back up with new wheat bran then pour them back into their re-stocked bin.

Many people try to give the best to their feeders since it will pay off when they give the worms to their Sugar gliders, and that couldn't be more true. You should use veggies that are fresh. The number one thing to use and one of my preferred choices are raw potatoes and apples. Many people use other veggies but I find these work best. Raw cut-up potatoes are cheap and easy to find. Keep in mind that if your bins ever seem moist you may have added too much vegetable material. The food can be replaced as often as you feel it is necessary. You can really use a variety of different things, even some carrots or greens. However keep away from peppers, onions, garlic or anything else with a strong flavor.

After a few months of doing this you will begin to see pupae. Your mealworms are fine. This is a good thing really because it's the first step towards breeding. See, when you start to see this it would be wise to store about a month's worth of mealworms in the fridge if you will need some of these mealworms to feed your animals. This will keep them from turning into pupae and you will use this stock while you're waiting for the next generation. Do not stick them in the freezer! Pick out the pupae when you clean the bins as noted before and place them in another clean bin with no worms. They do not need and food or water However, I place mine on wheat bran because in a week or so they will hatch out into beetles.

The beetle

Beetles almost never fly, only when they are starving will they try to fly out of the bin. The pupa will turn in to beetles. In about a week from there on that bin will be their new home. Keep placing new pupae in the bin as the mealworms change over. These beetles are harmless and even easier to care for. Just feed every so often, the same thing you feed the mealworms. Around week 5 or 6 you should see your first very small babies. If not, wait longer. This can take months. Once you do start seeing very small babies it's time to clean the bedding like you do with the worms but this time don't throw anything away. Keep the babies in a new bin and replace the beetles' bedding with new wheat bran. You can clean their bins again in another 5 weeks. (You can choose to clean more often or even less; this is all up to you). Keep cleaning and feeding your mealworms, beetles, and baby mealworms. Remember, the smaller the better. This lets them drop through the sifter when you sort out the beetles. Any bigger and it will not work. After you've separated the beetles out and you only have baby mealworm in the bin, feed them like all the rest, but remember babies can take months to grow up. The more you feed them the better they grow

To separate or to not separate that is the question Between mealworms, pupae, and beetles things can become a bit harder when you do not separate them. Every life stage

will pick the other and even kill no matter how much food you give them. You will have a high death rate on all sides! They will eat one another. Maybe not all... but enough for you to go "Oh my gosh what happened". It's better to hand-pick the stages away from other groups. Bedding will stay much cleaner and there will be less of a death rate for pupae. When bins seem too full of whatever it may be or high death rates of beetles it's a good thing to cull off some or pick out a few good ones. This way you can throw out the dead ones but still have some alive left over. Take a large bin and have a few handfulls at a time on one side then just pick up the live beetles that crawl to the other side. It goes faster if you have a light over them, but not too close or you can kill them.

GLIDER NAMES

Ace, AJ, Ajax, Al, Alex, Allister, Andy, Ant, Apollo, Archie, Arrow, Arthur, Astro, Avo, Azure,
 Bacon, Badger, Bailey, Bandit, Banji, Barkley, Barney, Bart, Basil, Batman, Beanie,
 BeeBee, Bennji, Bennie, Beno, Benson, Billy, Bingo, Biscuit, Blackie, Blaze, Blue, Bo,
 Bob, Bobbi, Bogey, Bolt, Boo, Boots, Bounty, Bozo, Brady, Braidy, Brandi, Bruno, Bud,
 Buffy, Bullet, Buster, Buttons, Buzz, Caesar, Cappy, Casey, Chaco, Chappi, Chester,
 Chico, Chino, Cigi, Cleo, Clover, Clyde, Coal, Cody, Colby, Conan, Cosmo, Cracker,
 Cyrus, Dakota, Daffy, Dakota, Damon, DanDee, Dante, Davinci, Deco, Dennis, Dexter,
 Diego, Diesel, Dino, Dixie, Dodger, Dody, Duffy, Duke, Ebin, Echo, Eddie, Elvis, Emo,
 Enzo, Eric, Ernie, Ewok, Fabio, Falcor, Fang, Fatso, Felix, Figaro, Finn, Fizz, Flip, Floyd,
 Fonzi, Fraz, Fred, Frisbee, Fritz, Frosty, Fudge, Fuji, Fury, Gambit, Garlic, Gato, Geo,
 Gerbie, Gible, Gilly, GinGin, Gizzy, G-Jo, Gobo, Godzilla, Gohan, Gomez, Goober,
 Gooch, Goofy, Gotcha, Gray, Griz, Groovy, Gucci, Gus, Guy, , Hank, Harley, Harpo,
 Harry, Hawk, Henri, Herbie, Hickory, Hippo, Homer, Homey, Hotaru, Houdini, gloo, Igor,
 Jasa, Jaide, Jake, James, Jamie, Jaws, Jayden, Jazz, Jean, Jeff, Jerry, Jesse, Jock, Joe, Joey,
 JoJo, Joker, Josie, Jumbo, Jumper, Kacy, Kashi, Kato, Kazoo, Keaton, Keemo, Khloe, KiKi,
 Kiko , Kimo, Kiros, Kit, Koa, Kobi, Kody, KoKo, Kola, Kozmo, Lamby, Larry, Lemon, Leo,
 Leroy, Limbo, , Lloyd, Loco, Logan, Luigi, Luke, Lupe, Mac, Maci, Mango, Manny, Marci,
 Mario, Matti, Max, Midget, Mieka, Miko, Milo, Misty, Mocha, Moe, Mojo, Monte, Munch,
 Muskey, Nacho, Naco, Naxo , Nelson, Nemmo, Neo, Nero, Nick, Nipper, Nips, Nipsey,
 Norman, Notty, Nugget, Nukey, Obie, Ochie, Odie, Oreo, Orion, Oskar, Ozzie, Pablo,
 Paco, Paddy, Pancho, Pauli, Peanut, Pepper, Pickles, Piper, Pookie, Popcorn, Popeye,
 Puck, Puddy, Pudge, Puff, Putter, Rabo, Raisin, Rambo, Randy, Rascal, Ray, Reggie, Rico,
 , Rio Rocco, Rocket, Rocky, Roger, Romeo, Roo, Rudy, Rumble, Rumpy, Sage, Sam,
 Scooter, Scruffles, Seth, Shadow, Shiloh, Shooter, Skyler, Smurf, Snoopy, Socks,
 Speedy, Spice, Spike, Spookie, Squirt, Starski, SugarBear, Sylvester, Taboo, Tac, Taco,
 Tails, , , Taz, Ted, Tex, Tigger, Timbo, Titus, Toby, Toi, Topaz, Travis, Tubby, Twinkles, Twix,
 Ubi, Ubu, Vargus, Vega, Wally, Webster, Wei, Whip, Whoopi, Will, Willow, Winston,
 Woody, Xac, Xanadu, Xavier, Xiao, , ylo, Yasmar, Yoda, Yodi, Yogi, Yogurt, Yo-yo, Zach,
 Zane, Zappy, Zeis, Zeus, Ziggy, Zing, Zippo, Zippy, Zoey, Zozo